

The Swing State Playbook: Take Back the Map

A field guide for stopping gerrymandering and fighting for fair elections in battleground states



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Swing states are where the lines matter most. One bad map can tip the balance of Congress, your statehouse, and your rights. But those lines don't draw themselves—and the good news is, they're not set in stone.

If you're in a swing state, your effort is critical. Here's how to fight back, right where you live and save democracy for all of us.

1. Know Who's Holding the Pen

- ☐ Look up how redistricting works in your state (start with your Secretary of State's website).
- ☐ Find out who draws the lines: is it your legislature, a redistricting commission, or a party-aligned consultant?
- ☐ Check if your county or city has its own redistricting process too. Local maps matter!

2. Stop the Next Power Grab Before It Starts

- ☐ Redistricting happens every 10 years, but the deals and maps are drafted *years in advance*.
- ☐ Mark your calendar: the next cycle is 2030. Start organizing *now*.
- ☐ If your state doesn't have an Independent Redistricting Commission (IRC), **push for one** through a ballot measure, state bill, or local ordinance.
- ☐ Swing state wins: Michigan and Arizona used ballot initiatives to stop gerrymandering cold.

3. Flood the Process With Fairness

- ☐ Attend every public hearing about redistricting—city, county, and state.
- ☐ Demand an open application process for any redistricting committees.
- ☐ Use [Districtr.org](https://districtr.org) to draw your own fair maps and submit them as public testimony.
- ☐ Rally your community to submit their own maps and comments too. (Numbers matter!)

4. Get in the Fight From the Inside

- ☐ Run for your local board of supervisors, city council, or school board—anywhere that touches redistricting.
- ☐ Volunteer with your local elections office or redistricting commission as a poll worker, data wrangler, or outreach lead.
- ☐ Join local watchdogs already working on redistricting—League of Women Voters, NAACP, and grassroots voting rights coalitions are key allies.

5. Build Your Own Oversight Team

- ☐ Start a local redistricting oversight group.
- ☐ Research your area's gerrymandering history and document the power players.
- ☐ Host a community mapping night: teach folks how redistricting works and how to fight for fair lines.
- ☐ Publicly track and report how your elected officials vote on map-related issues. Shine a light and name names.

6. Keep Your Eye on the Map

- ☐ Check how your current district lines affect your community. Are you split across districts that weaken your vote?
- ☐ Share stories of how gerrymandering silences voters—especially in BIPOC, rural, and urban communities.
- ☐ Pressure candidates and incumbents to take a public stand on fair maps.

Fair maps don't just protect democracy—they reflect it.

This is how we win the ground game. One district. One county. One coalition at a time.

Ready? Go Be loud. Be bold. Be *American*!

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